

white. For example, if you shoot a photo under a yellow tungsten lamp, all areas that should be white will have a yellow tinge to them, so you should tone down the yellow and boost the blue in the photo to get back to natural colours.

In the Image Adjustment area, you'll see sliders for Temperature and Tint. A photo's colour temperature is how "warm" or "cool" it looks—warm images look bathed in yellow, cooler images have a suffusion of blue. Use this slider only if your photo looks distinctly biased towards one end.

A better way to adjust white balance quickly is the White Balance tool—it's the third from the left on the toolbar. Select it and click on the area of the image that is supposed to be white or neutral grey—the Temperature and Tint settings will automatically be adjusted.

The Basic Image Adjustment Tab

Besides adjusting white balance, the Basic tab gives you options to tweak the tone of your image.

Exposure:

This slider lets you adjust the brightness of the image, but setting it too high could murder details; ditto too low.

Recovery:

This slider lets you recover details from the brighter areas of the image—if the texture of a wall is obliterated by direct sunlight, for example, Recovery will try and get it back for you.

Fill Light:

Fill light is the same as Recovery, only for darker areas of the image. It'll try to recover details from shadows in your photo, without turning blacks into grey.

Blacks:

The black level of a photo defines how dark an area needs to be to